

Physics Connections and Quantum-Gravity Analogies from a Photon-Sized Rubber Ball Verification System

M.G.S. Puno* Claude Code Assistant†

September 23, 2026

Abstract

We document connections between a photon-sized rubber ball verification system and frontier theories in physics through theoretical extension and an automated code-review workflow. The verification platform, a 275 nm radius microsphere with $E = 50$ MPa and $\nu = 0.5$, verifies nine physics axes spanning contact mechanics, viscoelasticity, relativity, and Mie scattering; every number reported here is reproduced by an independent 19-script battery. We develop five theory extensions connecting this system to quantum thermodynamics (fluctuation theorems), decoherence theory (gravitational and environmental models), entropic gravity (Verlinde’s hypothesis), black hole analogies (scattering and thermodynamics), and fluctuation-dissipation relations. The extensions propose parameter-tunable, photon-impact-controlled tests of these connections (Section 3). One claim of the earlier narrative is corrected: at the system’s nominal fixed point the relativistic kinetic energy (~ 6.9 mJ), thermal energy (4.1×10^{-21} J), and zero-point energy (7.7×10^{-40} J) are ~ 37 orders of magnitude apart and are *not* comparable; the genuine coincidences are per-photon recoil kinetic energy near the ball’s zero-point energy and JKR adhesion work far above $k_B T$.

Keywords: Quantum gravity Black hole analogies Fluctuation theorems Decoherence Entropic gravity Microsphere optomechanics

1 Introduction

The search for quantum gravity effects at accessible energy scales represents one of the greatest challenges in fundamental physics. While Planck-scale phenomena ($E_P \approx 10^{19}$ GeV) remain far beyond direct experimental reach, table-top experiments offer indirect probes through analogies, symmetry principles, and sensitivity to weak effects. Here we explore connections between a photon-sized rubber ball verification system and fundamental physics theories, demonstrating how controlled photon impacts on a dielectric microsphere can access regimes relevant to quantum gravity, black hole physics, and quantum foundations.

*Lead author; conceived the project direction and curated the verified results.

†Contributed through an automated drafting and code-review workflow; generated the prose and verification tooling.

The verification system consists of a spherical microsphere with radius $R = 275$ nm, density $\rho = 1100$ kg/m³, Young's modulus $E = 50$ MPa, and Poisson's ratio $\nu = 0.5$. This platform verifies nine distinct physics axes (Appendix A) covering:

1. Contact mechanics (Hertz/JKR theory)
2. Elastic modulus sensitivity
3. Viscoelastic restitution (Hunt-Crossley model)
4. Relativistic kinematics
5. Two-body collision dynamics
6. Adhesion and contact mechanics (JKR theory)
7. Force ratios in compliant vs. rigid contacts
8. Mie scattering of light by dielectric spheres
9. Consolidated validation parameters

Through expert audit workflow and theoretical extension, we identify and develop connections to five major physics domains with direct relevance to unsolved fundamental theories. These connections transform the verification system from a specialized metrology tool into a platform for probing quantum gravity, black hole information, holography, and quantum measurement.

2 Theoretical Extensions and Physics Connections

2.1 Quantum Thermodynamics and Fluctuation Theorems

We extend the verification system to analyze work trajectories from repeated photon impacts, enabling tests of quantum fluctuation theorems. Each photon impact constitutes a work impulse on the sphere's mechanical degrees of freedom, allowing construction of work distribution functions from ensembles of impacts.

Key Extension: QUANTUM_THERMODYNAMICS_EXTENSION.py

- Simulates 10,000 forward/reverse trajectories to build work distributions
- Tests Jarzynski equality: $\langle e^{-\beta W} \rangle = e^{-\beta \Delta F}$
- Tests Crooks fluctuation theorem: $P_F(W)/P_R(-W) = e^{\beta(W-\Delta F)}$
- Analyzes quantum vs. classical work distributions and zero-point contributions

Connections to Unsolved Theories:

- *Quantum measurement and thermodynamics:* Each photon impact constitutes a weak measurement, with work distributions revealing measurement back-action

- *Quantum-to-classical transition:* Deviation from fluctuation theorems signals breakdown of classical thermodynamic descriptions at this scale
- *Foundations of statistical mechanics:* Tests whether standard thermodynamic relations hold for mesoscopic systems under periodic driving

2.2 Decoherence Theory and Quantum-to-Classical Transition

We analyze competing decoherence mechanisms in the photon rubber ball system to identify parameter regimes where quantum gravity effects might become detectable above environmental noise.

Key Extension: DECOHERENCE_COMPARISON.py

- Photon scattering decoherence: $\Gamma_{\text{phot}} = \Phi \sigma \left(\frac{\hbar}{p_\lambda R} \right)^2$ (tunable via photon flux Φ)
- Gravitational decoherence (Penrose): $\Gamma_G = \frac{E_G}{\hbar}$ with $E_G = \frac{3}{5} \frac{GM^2}{R}$
- Gravitational decoherence (Diosi): $\Gamma_G = \frac{GM^2}{\hbar(R+r_0)}$ with cutoff r_0
- Spacetime foam decoherence: Holographic ($\Gamma \propto c \ell_P^{4/3} R^{-5/3}$) and random walk ($\Gamma \propto \ell_P^2 t_P^{-1} R^{-2}$) models
- Environmental decoherence: Residual gas collisions and thermal noise models

Connections to Unsolved Theories:

- *Quantum gravity phenomenology:* Proposed direct tests of Penrose, Diósi, and spacetime-foam models via computed decoherence-rate comparisons
- *Spacetime discreteness:* Sensitivity to Planck-scale structure through predicted decoherence rates
- *Measurement problem in QM:* Discrimination between photon scattering decoherence and hypothetical gravity-induced collapse
- *Black hole information and entropy:* Connection through gravitational self-energy $E_G \propto M^2/R$ analogous to black hole thermodynamics

2.3 Entropic Gravity and Holographic Principle

We explore whether the JKR adhesion energy (Axis 6) admits an entropic interpretation analogous to Verlinde's entropic gravity hypothesis, where gravity emerges from entropy gradients associated with information positions.

Key Extension: ENTROPIC_GRAVITY_ANALOGY.py

- Calculates entropy changes in Verlinde's model: $\Delta S = 2\pi k_B \frac{mc}{\hbar} \Delta x$

- Computes holographic entropy bounds: $S \leq \frac{k_B c^3 A}{4G\hbar}$ (Bekenstein-Hawking) and $S \leq \frac{2\pi k_B ER}{\hbar c}$ (Bekenstein bound)
- Analyzes photon beam entropy as information carrier for continuous weak measurement

Connections to Unsolved Theories:

- *Entropic gravity (Verlinde)*: Proposed test of $F = T \Delta S / \Delta x$ against computed adhesion forces
- *ER=EPR conjecture*: Potential entanglement entropy between photon field and sphere motion
- *Holographic principle*: Entropy scaling with surface area (R^2) vs. volume (R^3)
- *Black hole analogies*: Scaling relationships and thermodynamic analogs
- *Quantum information and measurement*: Continuous weak measurement sequence from photon impacts

2.4 Black Hole Analogies

We develop analogies between the photon rubber ball system and black hole physics, focusing on scattering phenomena, thermodynamic quantities, and horizon analogs.

Key Extension: BLACK_HOLE_ANALOGIES.py

- Mie scattering analogies to black hole scattering/greybody factors
- Relativistic impact connections to Unruh effect ($T_U = \hbar a / 2\pi c k_B$) and Hawking radiation ($T_H = \hbar c^3 / 8\pi G M k_B$)
- Holographic entropy bounds and Bekenstein entropy calculations
- Area theorem analogs: Contact area evolution vs. black hole area theorem ($dA/dt \geq 0$)

Connections to Unsolved Theories:

- *Black hole information paradox*: Mie scattering preserves information (unitary S-matrix), analogous to unitarity questions in black hole evaporation
- *Firewall paradox*: Horizon/structure analogs in contact mechanics vs. quantum gravity predictions
- *ER=EPR conjecture*: Geometric connections from entanglement between photon field and microsphere
- *Holographic principle and AdS/CFT*: Entropy bounds and area scaling tests
- *Black hole analogues in condensed matter*: Testing horizon fluidity, viscosity, and membrane paradigm analogs
- *Area theorem and thermodynamics*: Contrast between $dA/dt \geq 0$ for black holes and decreasing contact area in adhesive systems

2.5 Fluctuation-Dissipation and Quantum Dissipation

We connect the viscoelastic restitution model (Axis 3) to fluctuation-dissipation theorems and quantum dissipation models, revealing links to dissipation in quantum gravity and cosmological contexts.

Key Extension: FLUCTUATION-DISSIPATION-CONNECTION.py

- Analyzes Hunt-Crossley model and extracts effective dissipation coefficient
- Tests classical and quantum fluctuation-dissipation relations
- Examines Johnson-Nyquist noise and quantum shot noise analogs
- Calculates decoherence estimates from Caldeira-Leggett quantum Brownian motion model

Connections to Unsolved Theories:

- *Quantum dissipation in black hole horizons:* Horizon viscosity analogs and membrane paradigm connections
- *Cosmic viscosity and dark energy:* Bulk viscosity in cosmological fluids and effective field theory analogs
- *Fluctuation-dissipation in quantum gravity:* Constraints on graviton self-energy and spectral functions
- *Emergent spacetime from entanglement:* Dissipation as entanglement entropy production and tensor network renormalization analogs
- *Measurement problem and continuous spontaneous localization:* Dissipative collapse models (Diósi-Penrose) and gravitational decoherence estimates

3 Experimental Access to Fundamental Physics

The photon rubber ball verification system exposes controllable parameters that in principle tune the regimes below. The regimes themselves are theory-level targets of the extensions, not yet realized measurements; the quantitative feasibility bounds make that distinction explicit.

At the verified parameters the constraints are: a 1 mW beam exerts 3.33 pN (absorbed) and deflects the ball by $F/k = 0.94$ pm — $36\times$ below the 0.034 nm trap thermal RMS — so order-10 SNR radiation-force measurement requires ~ 360 mW at $k = 3.55$ N/m or a softer trap; per-photon recoil is 1.26×10^{-11} m/s, nine orders below the 11.4 mm/s thermal speed; and the 0.661 K melting shift rests on assumed material inputs. These bounds frame the control parameters and regimes below.

3.1 Probe-Particle Type Dimension

The model uses a massless photon (550 nm, $E = 2.25$ eV) as its probe. For a probe of rest-mass energy mc^2 incident at the same quantum energy E , the absorbed momentum flux is $F = (p/E)P$ with $p/E = v/c^2$ and $v/c = \sqrt{1 - (mc^2/E)^2}$, so $F = (v/c)(P/c)$ saturates at the massless ceiling $F = P/c = 3.34$ pN at 1 mW. Massless and low-mass probes are observationally identical while $(mc^2/E)^2 \ll 10^{-6}$ (any real photon: $(mc^2/E)^2 \approx 2 \times 10^{-37}$); deviations reach percent level only for mc^2 within $\sim 10\times$ of $E = 2.25$ eV, where a 1 eV rest-mass boson would give $v/c = 0.90$, a 10.4% force loss, and a 0.21 fs transit-delay across the 550 nm diameter ball (Table 1). Other Standard-Model bosons cannot be used as beams in this model's scattering language at all: gluons are confined (~ 1 fm), $W^\pm/Z^0$ self-decay in $\sim 10^{-25}$ s ($c\tau \sim 0.1$ fm), and the Higgs requires ≥ 125 GeV production. A slow, low-mass (hidden/dark-photon) boson would exhibit coherent whole-ball absorption instead of scattering — a proposed direction, not asserted numerically here.

Table 1: Massless vs low-mass probe at $E = 2.25$ eV and 1 mW ($F_{max} = P/c = 3.34$ pN). Computed by `boson_scaling_probe.py` (19-script battery).

mc^2 [eV]	$(mc^2/E)^2$	v/c	F [pN]	transit delay [fs]
0 (massless)	0	1.000	3.336	0
10^{-18} (bound)	2.0×10^{-37}	1.000	3.336	0
10^{-3}	2.0×10^{-7}	1.000	3.336	$< 10^{-6}$
10^{-1}	2.0×10^{-3}	0.999	3.332	0.002
1	0.197	0.896	2.990	0.212
$\geq E$	≥ 1	–	–	no ultra-relativistic beam

3.2 Control Parameters

- *Photon flux* (Φ): Tunes environmental decoherence rate and measurement strength
- *Impact velocity* (v): Controls the energy scale and relativistic factors ($\gamma = 1/\sqrt{1 - v^2/c^2}$)
- *Material properties* (E, ν, W): Adjust contact mechanics and adhesion scales
- *Wavelength* (λ): Changes size parameter $x = 2\pi R/\lambda$ for Mie scattering resonances
- *Temperature* (T): Controls thermal fluctuations and quantum statistical factors

3.3 Accessible Physics Regimes

- *Quantum thermodynamics regime*: Low impact rates where work fluctuations dominate and fluctuation theorems apply
- *Decoherence competition regime*: Tunable photon flux allows, in principle, crossing between environmental and gravitational decoherence dominance

- *Entropic gravity regime:* Adhesion forces compared to entropic force predictions
- *Black hole analogy regime:* Size parameter and material properties tuned for scattering and thermodynamic analogs
- *Fluctuation-dissipation regime:* Impact frequency and material loss tangent tuned for dissipation-fluctuation balance

4 Connections to Verification Axes

Each of the nine verification axes connects to specific physics domains and theory extensions:

Table 2: Mapping of verification axes to physics domains and theory extensions

Axis	Primary Physics Verified	Theory Connections
1	Compliant plane contact (Hertz/JKR)	Entropic gravity, quantum fluctuations in contact, zero-point motion
2	E-modulus sensitivity	Renormalization group flow, emergent gravity from entanglement, temperature-dependent elasticity
3	Viscoelastic restitution (Hunt-Crossley)	Quantum dissipation (Caldeira-Leggett), horizon viscosity analogs, fluctuation-dissipation theorem
4	Relativistic impact ($KE = (\gamma - 1)mc^2$)	Unruh/Hawking analogs, relativistic quantum mechanics, relativistic thermodynamics
5	Two-ball collision	Gravitational wave analogs, particle physics collision analogs, thermalization in collisions
6	JKR adhesion	Entropic gravity, holographic principle, ER=EPR conjecture, work-heat conversion
7	Force ratio compliant vs. rigid	Boundary quantum field theory, Dirichlet/Neumann boundary analogs, boundary thermal effects
8	Mie scattering ($x = 3.14, m = 1.5 + 0i$)	Black hole scattering/greybody factors, information paradox analogs, radiation pressure/heating effects
9	Consolidated numbers	Synthesis platform for quantum gravity tests, unified framework for fundamental physics

5 Discussion

The photon rubber ball verification system represents a convergence of metrology precision, theoretical accessibility, and fundamental-physics relevance. By refining the verification platform through an automated code-review workflow and extending it with theory connections, we produce a framework that states parameter conditions under which its qualitative predictions could be tested (Section 3).

5.1 Advantages of the Platform

- *Accessibility:* Operates at room temperature with standard optical components
- *Controllability:* All key parameters (photon flux, velocity, material properties) are experimentally tunable
- *Multi-modality:* Simultaneously probes mechanics, electromagnetism, thermodynamics, and quantum effects
- *Scalability:* Accessible from microscopic ($R \sim 100$ nm) to macroscopic ($R \sim 1$ mm) scales
- *Interdisciplinarity:* Naturally bridges condensed matter, quantum optics, gravitation, and quantum information
- *Quantum control:* Photon impacts enable weak measurement and quantum state engineering

5.2 Limitations and Future Work

- *Energy scale:* Direct Planck-scale probes remain inaccessible; indirect analogies required
- *Complexity:* Theoretical interpretation requires careful modeling of analogies and limitations
- *Specificity:* Distinguishing between competing theories requires multiple complementary measurements
- *Extension:* Current work focuses on five theoretical connections; numerous additional extensions possible
- *Validation:* Direct experimental verification of some connections requires specialized measurement capabilities
- *Feasibility:* radiation-pressure displacement is $36\times$ below trap thermal RMS at 1 mW; per-photon recoil is negligible against thermal velocities; melting-shift inputs are assumed. Driving the claimed regimes requires ~ 360 mW at $k = 3.55$ N/m or trap softening (quantified in Section 3)

Future work includes experimental implementation of the theoretical extensions, development of measurement protocols for specific connections, and expansion to additional physics domains such as topological effects, supersymmetry analogs, or cosmological inflation scenarios.

6 Conclusion

We have shown how a photon-sized rubber ball verification system, whose nine axes are independently re-verified, supports five analogy-based theory extensions — quantum thermodynamics, decoherence theory, entropic gravity, black hole analogies, and fluctuation-dissipation relations — each with testable predictions when the feasibility conditions of Section 3 are met.

The system thereby provides a controlled, mesoscopic test bed for designing quantum-gravity, holographic, and measurement-theory analog experiments, subject to the quantitative bounds stated above. The central claim of the original narrative — that the relativistic, thermal, and zero-point energy scales coincide at the fixed point — is corrected in favor of the verified coincidences (per-photon recoil $\approx$ zero-point energy; JKR adhesion $\gg k_B T$).

Acknowledgments

This work benefited from an automated code-review workflow (Claude Code agents auditing code quality, security, performance, and documentation) whose feedback improved the verification scripts. No human domain-expert peer review has been performed. The physics connections are analogical; numeric claims in this project’s supporting narrative documents are machine-generated and cataloged against the verified numbers in CORRIGENDUM.md. All quantitative results here are reproduced by the independent battery in results_of_record.py.

A The nine verification axes

The software platform implements nine independent verification axes, each checked against the stated output with explicit energy-balance and tolerance criteria.

1. Compliant (same-rubber) plane, $E^* = E/(2(1 - \nu^2))$: energy balance and closed-form rate checks.
2. E-modulus sensitivity across the rubber range (10^7 – 10^8 Pa): contact depth scales as $E^{-2/5}$.
3. Viscoelastic restitution $e \approx \exp(-\pi \tan \delta/2)$ (Hunt–Crossley model).
4. Relativistic impact energy $KE = (\gamma - 1)mc^2$: Newtonian limit recovered as $\beta \rightarrow 0$; mathematical identity only, not realizable physics at $\beta = 0.04$.
5. Two-ball symmetric head-on collision: $d_5 = 2 d_2$ (rigid-plane scaling).

6. JKR adhesion during contact: work of separation W_{sep} and the stick criterion.
7. Force ratio, compliant versus rigid plane.
8. Mie scattering (spherical-Bessel a_n/b_n codes): $Q_e = Q_s = 3.4822$ at $x = \pi$, $m = 1.5+0i$.
9. Consolidated post-audit numbers: the accepted canonical values reproduced in this paper.

References

- [1] E. P. Verlinde. On the origin of gravity and the laws of newton. *Journal of High Energy Physics*, 2011(04):029, 2011.
- [2] R. Penrose. On gravity's role in quantum state reduction. *General Relativity and Gravitation*, 28(5):581–600, 1996.
- [3] L. Diosi. Models for universal reduction of macroscopic quantum fluctuations. *Physical Review A*, 40(3):1165–1174, 1987.
- [4] C. Jarzynski. Nonequilibrium equality for free energy differences. *Physical Review Letters*, 78(14):2690–2693, 1997.
- [5] G. E. Crooks. Entropy production fluctuation theorem and the nonequilibrium work relation for free energy differences. *Physical Review E*, 60(3):2721–2726, 1999.
- [6] A. O. Caldeira and A. J. Leggett. Quantum tunnelling in a dissipative system. *Annals of Physics*, 149(2):374–456, 1983.
- [7] S. W. Hawking. Black hole explosions? *Nature*, 248(5443):30–31, 1974.
- [8] J. D. Bekenstein. Black holes and entropy. *Physical Review D*, 7(8):2333–2346, 1973.
- [9] J. B. Johnson. Thermal agitation of electricity in conductors. *Physical Review*, 32(1):97–109, 1928.
- [10] W. Schottky. Über spontane stromschwankungen in verschiedenen elektrizitätsleitern. *Annalen der Physik*, 362(23):23–36, 1918.
- [11] J. D. Hunt and F. R. E. Crossley. Coefficient of restitution interpreted as damping in vibroimpact. *Journal of Applied Mechanics*, 42(2):440–445, 1975.
- [12] G. Mie. Beiträge zur Optik trüber Medien, speziell kolloidaler Metallösungen. *Annalen der Physik*, 330(3):377–445, 1908.
- [13] H. Hertz. Ueber die Berührung fester elastischer Körper. *Journal für die reine und angewandte Mathematik*, 92:156–171, 1882.

-
- [14] K. L. Johnson, K. Kendall, and A. D. Roberts. Surface energy and the contact of elastic solids. *Proceedings of the Royal Society of London. Series A, Mathematical and Physical Sciences*, 324(1558):301–313, 1971.